events. Did anybody ask this of Roosevelt after Pearl Harbor? Did anybody ask this of Bush after 9/11? These were his standard answers. He promised that after the war all questions would be dealt with, including that of his responsibility. We know what his defense will be: no one in the army or his entire defense and security establishment gave him a warning. How could he know?

By declaring for the nth time that Israel will keep control of security in the Gaza Strip after the war, Netanyahu wants to appear as the strong, no-nonsense leader that he failed to be before October 7. But he is running into a trap that the Americans know well, after Iraq and Afghanistan. By refusing to share power with the Palestinian Authority or promise it the possibility of a two-state solution, Israel will face a growing radicalization of the Gaza Palestinians and those of the West Bank, and the rebirth of Hamas, be it under another name. Nobody can be assured that this will not occur in any case, but there is a much better chance of avoiding such radicalization by showing a readiness to support what most Palestinians demand: a state of their own.

According to the *Washington Post*, maps and instructions that were found in possession of one of the Hamas units that attacked Israel on October 7 show that the aim of the attackers was to reach the West Bank, which would have represented an immense victory for Hamas, not only against Israel but also against the Palestinian Authority. In their eyes, it would have demonstrated their ability to liberate the whole of Palestine.

As a complement to this rosy picture, it became apparent over the last days that, although there is a war cabinet for social and economic matters, there is complete chaos and indifference all around, as if there were no war and no urgent matters to deal with. In short, those responsible are deeply asleep and Finance Minister Smotrich has more important matters on his agenda.